

Observation Sheet

A PG Ledger observation record for one bounded place, plot, or observation frame. Use it when an observation is worth preserving; it is not a monthly duty. The eight categories are a land-based starter grammar, not universal indicators. Adapt them to place and local knowledge. Format 2 v1.2 · August 2026 · Candidate tool.

Place / observation frame / privacy code: _____ Date: _____

Weather: _____ Observer: _____

Use this sheet by local agreement for a visit, planting, pruning, weather event, care action, or other change worth recording. Choose what fits; mark N/A where a category does not fit and name uncertainty rather than forcing an answer.

Decisive question:
Is this practice giving to life?

1 Soil cover

Is the surface covered or bare?

☐ Covered ☐ Partial ☐ Bare

2 Vegetation layering

Are multiple layers present?

☐ Layered ☐ Partial ☐ Flat / mono

3 Water behaviour

Does water infiltrate or run off?

☐ Absorbs ☐ Mixed ☐ Runs off

4 Succession signals

Is the system becoming more complex?

☐ Advancing ☐ Holding ☐ Resetting

5 Biodiversity presence

What species are present — plants, insects, birds?

☐ Diverse ☐ Some ☐ Absent

6 Soil health signals

Smell, texture, earthworms, fungal signs?

☐ Alive ☐ Mixed ☐ Flat / hard

7 Biomass cycle

Is organic matter returned or removed?

☐ Returned ☐ Partial ☐ Removed

8 Human rhythm

Is the work rhythm sustainable for the people doing it?

☐ Sustainable ☐ Strained ☐ Depleted

NOTES Actions, local knowledge, uncertainty, and what to carry forward

Actions since last relevant observation

What the place seems to need next / uncertainty:
noticed · inferred · known

What changed or surprised you / local knowledge note

N/A categories and why / sketch or photo reference

Remember: An honest gap or uncertainty is more valuable than a fabricated green.

Local knowledge is shared only with consent. Use this sheet only when something is worth preserving. If it contributes to an agreed PG Ledger, keep, date, and file it according to the evidence and privacy practice held for that relationship.

Is this practice giving to life?